Netflix Celebrates 10 Years of Korean Stories in Seoul

From: Variety Mined: 2026-10-25 5 min read

Stars from "Squid Game" and "KPop Demon Hunters" took the stage in Seoul on October 24 as Netflix celebrated 10 years in Korea with a fan festival. The two-day event, called Netflix Janchi, ran October 24-25 at Sangam Oil Tank Culture Park, where thousands of fans enjoyed themed booths, games, **merchandise**, and live music.

"Squid Game" was represented by Lee Jung-jae, Lee Byung-hun, and Park Hae-soo, while Ahn Hyo-seop appeared for "KPop Demon Hunters." Other stars included Koo Kyo-hwan and Jung Hae-in of "D.P.," Kim Hyun-joo of "Hellbound," and Yum Hye-ran of "Mask Girl."

"Ten years ago, we dreamed big. But none of us could have imagined that Korean stories would move hearts around the world, and land right at the center of global culture," said Netflix co-CEO Ted Sarandos. He **previewed** "Possible Love," Lee Chang-dong's Venice winner, arriving November 6, and "Tantara," starring Song Hye-kyo, Gong Yoo, and Kim Seol-hyun, following on December 11. Still undated are "Grand Galaxy Hotel," "She, Wolf," "All of Us Are Dead" Season 2, and "Solo Leveling."

Netflix launched in Korea on January 6, 2016. Its first international film was Bong Joon Ho's "Okja." The first Korean **original**, the **stand-up** special "Yoo Byung Jae: Too Much Information," arrived in March 2018, and "Kingdom" became its first Korean series in January 2019. In July 2021, "Kingdom: Ashin of the North" became the first Korean show to enter the Global Top 10, charting in 58 countries.

Netflix has counted more than 200 Korean titles on its Global Top 10 since June 2021. "Squid Game" Season 1 holds the record for the longest run, at 32 straight weeks, nine at number one. Its three seasons are the streamer's three most-watched non-English series ever, and more than four in five **subscribers** worldwide have sampled at least one Korean title. "For Netflix, Korea is more than a market. It is where we discovered new possibilities, and where we learned how far a story can travel," Sarandos said.

Word Treasure

merchandise -- Goods such as toys, clothes, or posters made to sell to fans of a show.
subscribers -- People who pay to use a service such as Netflix.
previewed -- Showed a first look at something before it is released.
original -- A show or film made by Netflix itself, not bought from someone else.
stand-up -- A kind of comedy show where one person tells jokes on stage.

Background you need

Netflix is a streaming service that lets people watch shows and films over the internet, and it makes its own original shows in many countries.

Korean stories are shows and films made in Korea, in the Korean language, which have found fans far beyond Korea.

A fan festival is a public event where fans meet stars, play games, and enjoy themed booths and live music celebrating the shows they love.

The Global Top 10 is Netflix's chart of its most-watched titles around the world, so entering it means a show is being watched in many countries at once.

Break it down

LEAD: Netflix celebrated 10 years in Korea with a fan festival in Seoul
KEY EVENT: Netflix Janchi, a two-day fan festival at Sangam Oil Tank Culture Park
+- WHO: Stars from Squid Game, KPop Demon Hunters, D.P., Hellbound, and Mask Girl
+- WHEN: October 24-25
+- WHAT: Themed booths, games, merchandise, and live music for thousands of fans
EVIDENCE: More than 200 Korean titles have entered the Global Top 10 since June 2021, and Squid Game's three seasons are the most-watched non-English series
PREVIEWS: Possible Love arrives November 6 and Tantara follows on December 11
OPEN QUESTION: When the still-undated titles, including All of Us Are Dead Season 2 and Solo Leveling, will arrive

Why it matters

Korean stories have grown from one country's shows into some of the world's most-watched series, showing how a story told in one language can travel across the globe.

Test what you remember

1. Where did Netflix celebrate 10 years in Korea?

- (A) London
- (B) Seoul
- (C) Busan
- (D) Tokyo

2. What was the two-day event called?

- (A) Seoul Music Week
- (B) Korea Fest
- (C) Squid Game Live
- (D) Netflix Janchi

3. Which show was represented by Lee Jung-jae, Lee Byung-hun, and Park Hae-soo?

- (A) Hellbound
- (B) Mask Girl
- (C) D.P.
- (D) Squid Game

4. When did Netflix launch in Korea?

- (A) January 6, 2016
- (B) March 2018
- (C) January 2019
- (D) July 2021

5. What was Netflix's first Korean series?

- (A) Okja
- (B) Kingdom
- (C) Squid Game
- (D) Kingdom: Ashin of the North

6. How long did "Squid Game" Season 1 stay on the Global Top 10?

- (A) 58 weeks
- (B) 200 weeks
- (C) 32 straight weeks
- (D) Nine weeks

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: A 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Netflix co-CEO Ted Sarandos: For Netflix, Korea is more than a market; it is where the company discovered new possibilities and learned how far a story can travel.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):